

Psalms 93

The Lord Reigneth

The Lord reigneth, he is clothed with majesty... thy throne is established of old
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *The LORD reigneth, he is clothed with majesty; the LORD is clothed with strength, wherewith he hath girded himself: the world also is stablished, that it cannot be moved.*
- 2 *Thy throne is established of old: thou art from everlasting.*
- 3 *The floods have lifted up, O LORD, the floods have lifted up their voice; the floods lift up their waves.*
- 4 *The LORD on high is mightier than the noise of many waters, yea, than the mighty waves of the sea.*
- 5 *Thy testimonies are very sure: holiness becometh thine house, O LORD, for ever.*

2 · CONTEXT

A brief but forceful declaration of God's kingship, likely composed to be sung amid the roar of real, threatening circumstances—floods, waves, chaos—that the psalm deliberately subordinates to God's greater and older authority. Henry treats its central image, the flood 'lifting up its voice' against a throne that was established long before any flood existed, as the psalm's whole argument in miniature: whatever noise chaos makes, it is not new, and it is not sovereign.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The declaration opens flatly: the Lord reigns, clothed with majesty, girded with strength as with a belt. The world itself is established, unmoved; God's throne has been established of old, and He Himself is from everlasting—His authority did not begin in response to any current crisis.

Verse 3-4

The floods are personified, lifting up their voice, lifting up their waves, in loud and repeated tumult. Yet the Lord on high is mightier than the noise of many waters, mightier than the waves of the sea—might measured directly against the loudest, most chaotic force the psalmist can picture.

Verse 5

The psalm closes by turning from cosmic imagery to covenant reliability: God's testimonies are very sure, and holiness becomes His house forever—stability in His word matched by fittingness in His worship.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Whatever chaos currently roars the loudest—circumstances, opposition, sheer noise and tumult—is not as old, as strong, or as sovereign as the throne of God, established long before the current crisis existed and secure long after it passes. Confidence rests not in silencing the noise but in recognizing whose authority actually outranks it.

Application for life today.

When circumstances feel as loud and relentless as floods lifting their voice, resist measuring God's power only against the volume of the crisis; deliberately recall, as this psalm does, that His throne predates and outlasts it. Let verse 5's confidence in God's 'very sure' testimonies steady you when you are tempted to doubt His word simply because the noise around you is loud. Consider what it means practically for holiness to 'become' God's house—worship shaped by the certainty that He, not the chaos, reigns.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What current 'flood'—a loud, chaotic circumstance—is tempting you to measure God's power only against its volume rather than His actual authority (vv. 3–4)?

2. How does remembering that God's throne was 'established of old' (v. 2), long before this crisis, change your posture toward it?

3. What would it look like for holiness to genuinely 'become' the way you approach worship this week (v. 5), rather than being an afterthought?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).